LangChain CharacterTextSplitter Produces Chunks Larger Than chunk_size

Developer evidence stackoverflow **# 76633836** GitHub **# 10410**

1. The developer configured chunk_size=6, expecting chunks of at most six characters, but received one 26-character chunk.
2. The developer reported that the documentation did not explain why chunk_size failed to enforce the expected limit.

```
from langchain.text_splitter import
CharacterTextSplitter

splitter = CharacterTextSplitter(
    chunk_size=6, chunk_overlap=2
)
splitter.split_text("abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz")

# ['abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz']
```

Observed problem: CharacterTextSplitter.split_text returned the entire 26-character input as a single chunk despite chunk_size=6, because no matching separator existed.

LangChain **(Version 0.0.285)**

```
..
splits = _split_text_with_regex(
    text, separator, self._keep_separator
)
..
return self._merge_splits(splits, _separator)
```

Key evidence: split_text splits at configured separators; _merge_splits does not subdivide oversized individual segments.

Documentation gap: Documentation (V 0.0.285) does not explain that chunk_size is not a strict upper bound.

MINT

Multi-Agent Contract Inference

Contract Normalization

API `CharacterTextSplitter.split_text`

Contract 1: split_text splits text only at occurrences of its configured separator (default "\n\n"). When no matching separator exists, the entire text is returned as a single chunk, even if its length exceeds chunk_size.

Contract 2: chunk_size is a best-effort maximum, not a strict upper bound. When the smallest separator-delimited piece exceeds chunk_size, the method may return a chunk larger than the configured limit.

Multi-Agent Contract Review: Supported and Complete

Human Validated **Taxonomy:** Intra-argument Contract